INCH-POUND

MIL-C-63989C (AR)
AMENDMENT 2
15 SEPTEMBER 1996
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 1
28 February 1995

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, 5.56mm, BALL, M855

This amendment forms a part of MIL-C-63989 (AR), dated 15 February 1994, and is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Research, Development and Engineering Center, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 12

TABLE I Under Examination or Test Column, delete "Critical" and substitute "Critical/Special"

PAGE 13

4.5.6 Delete the last sentence and substitute the following:

"If a visual critical or special defect is found in a sample either just prior to a firing test or after a firing test (and the defect is not due to the firing), the lot shall be rejected."

PAGE 15

Delete page 15 in its entirety and substitute new page 15 included as page 2.

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CLASSIFICATION OF CHARACTERISTICS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.5.6.1	Cartridge, 5.56mm, Ball: M855 (Inspection)	1 OF 3	9342868
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable

CLASSIFICATION	EXAMINATION OR TEST	CONFORMANCE CRITERIA	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	INSPECTION METHOD REFERENCE
CRITICAL				
1.	Perforated case (7)	100%	3.1	Gage
2.	Case split in K,L or M location (6)	100%	3.1	Gage
3.	Weight, min 1/	100%	3.1	see note 2/
4.	Case split I,S or J location when it is determined that there is a potential for loss of propellant.	100%	3.1	Gage
SPECIAL				
a.	Primer missing (32)	100%	3.1	Visual
b.	Primer cocked (33)	100%	3.1	Visual
c.	Primer inverted (34)	100%	3.1	Visual
MAJOR				
101.	Total length	Level I	3.1	Gage
102.	Case split in I,S or J location when it is determined that there is no potential for loss of propellant.	100%	3.1	Gage
103.	Corrosion or stain with etching (2)	Level I	3.1	Visual
104.	Chamfer missing on head (rim) (13) 100%	Level I	3.1	Visual

NOTES:
1/ Each lightweight cartridge shall be disassembled and the propellant weighed. Any cartridge containing less than 13 grains of propellant shall be classed as a critical defect. Any cartridge containing 13 grains or more of propellant shall be classed as a major defect. 2/ One hundred percent examination for weight may be either by weighing or by measuring for propellant fill; method used must be capable of detecting a cartridge containing less than 13 grains of propellant. 3/ refer to MIL-STD-636 (NATO Caliber 7.62 Section) for visual defect standards for defects 1 through 38. Inspection for visual defects may be performed employing an automated inspection system that has been approved by the Government.

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Table III Under Test column, add "3/" after CETME L5.56.

PAGE 22

* Table IV Under "a. Perforation of firing pin indent in primer cup" Delete the following:

"(1) M249 Machine Gun	0	see 3/	1" and substitute
"(1) M249 Machine Gun	0	28(see 3/)	40"

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* Note 3 Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"If defects in excess of the acceptance number in table IV are noted in the first sample, a second sample consisting of double the quantity of cartridges specified under function and casualty in table III shall be fired in both weapons. Prior to the testing of the second sample, the firing pin of the specific weapon in which the defect occurred shall be replaced with a new firing pin. If the cumulative number of defects from both the first and second sample exceeds the cumulative acceptance number in Table IV, the lot shall be rejected."

The margins of this amendment are marked with an asterisk or vertical lines to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in this notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous amendment.

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